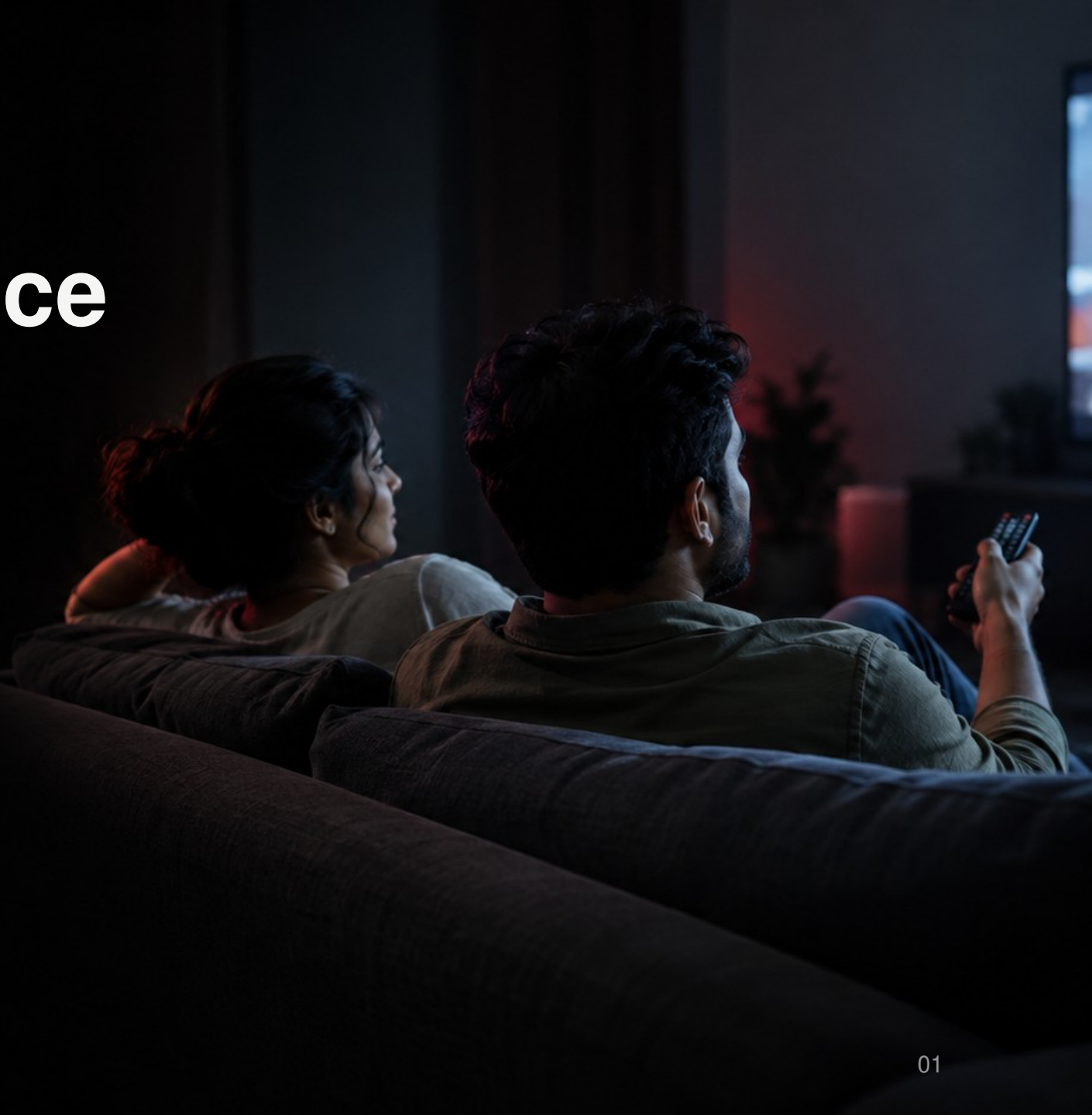


by ANAMIKA NAYAK

How I would reduce decision fatigue on Netflix

For shared households

Helping two people find a film they both want to start



Finding something to watch carries a cost

Industry evidence gives this problem weight, but does not size Netflix's household opportunity

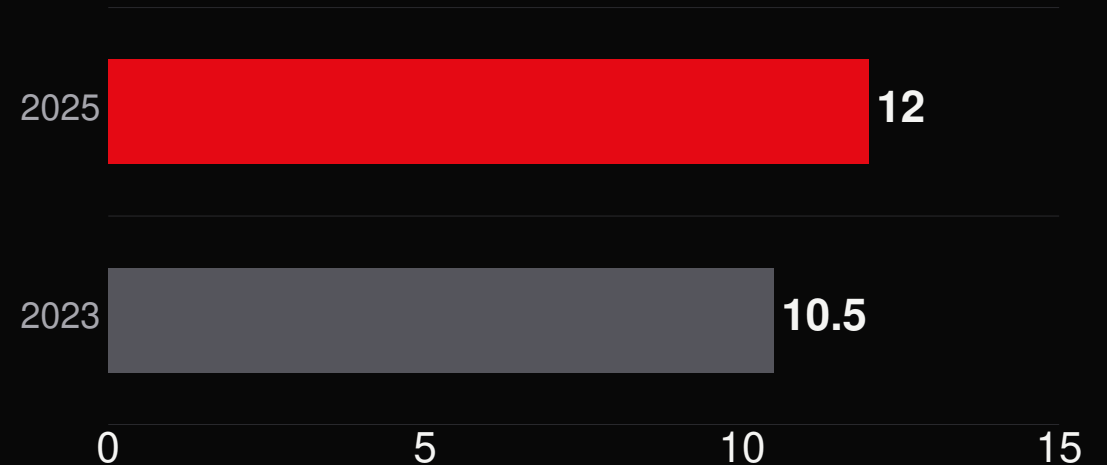
12 min

Average reported search time
among U.S. streaming viewers in 2025

19%

Reported abandoning viewing
when search was
unsuccessful

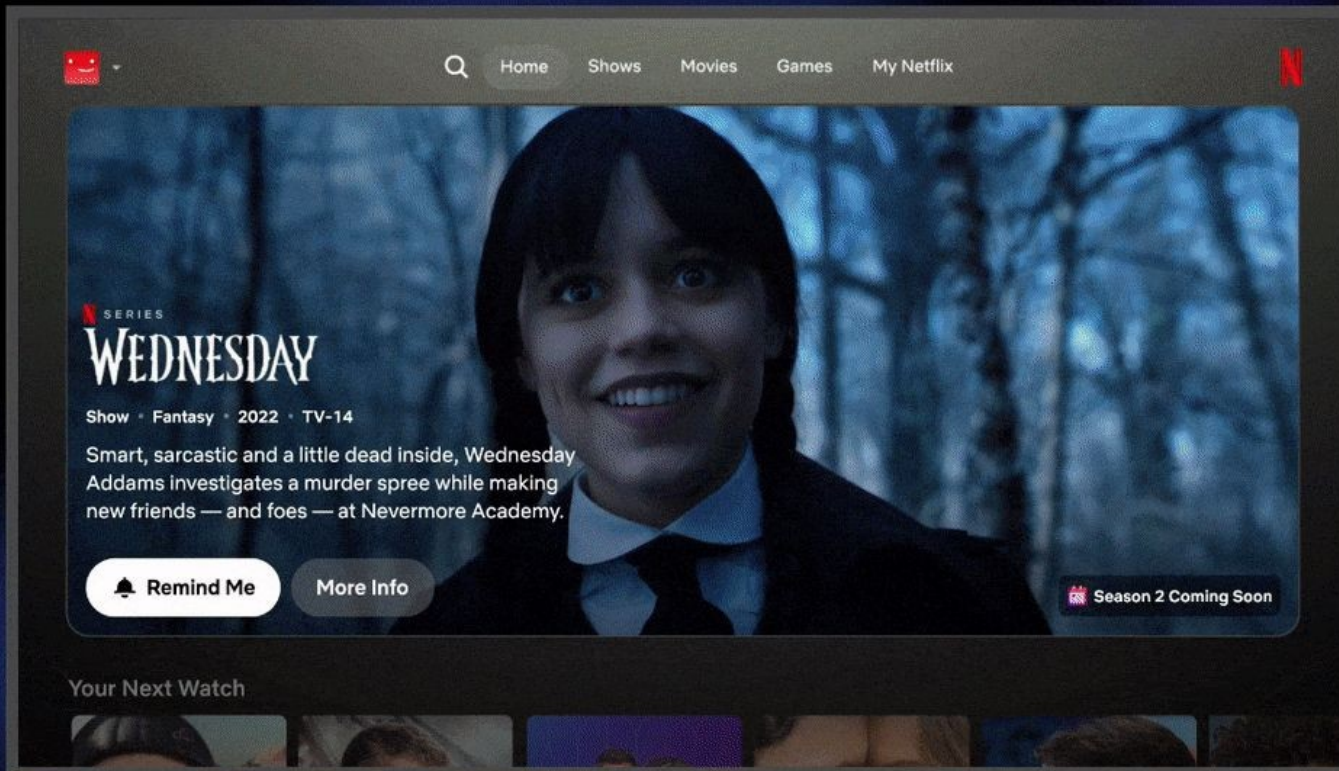
Reported U.S. search time, minutes



Gracenote 2025 survey: 3,000 consumers across six countries. Self-reported, cross-service evidence.

Netflix already invests in discovery

The opportunity is to make the people watching together explicit



What Netflix documents

Personal profiles
Suggestions and My List

Responsive recommendations
More visible shortcuts

Opportunity hypothesis

An explicit shared session could help two viewers agree sooner.

Two adults choosing a film together

Job hypothesis: find a film we both accept, without one person managing the whole search

Evidence

A 12-person Netflix study found choice overload alongside benefits from recommendation lists.

Small qualitative sample. Interviews in 2023.
Published in 2024, before the TV redesign.

What I would validate

Repeated vetoes restart the search.
One person carries the decision effort.
Tonight's preferences differ from history.

Proposed research

12 households, 7-day diary, then joint
and separate interviews with both viewers.

Proceed only if agreement friction recurs and is addressable. A prototype must save more time than setup adds.

Choose together

Proposed TV experience. The interface and film artwork below are illustrative

01

Confirm the pair

Two opted-in adult profiles.
Optional mood and time limit.

02

Compare three films

A small, explainable shortlist.
Either person can say no.

Choose together

Alex + Sam

A few films for tonight

Under 2 hours · Light-hearted



Fits tonight's mood and time



▶ Play

Not tonight

Adjust filters

← Back to browsing

The MVP concentrates on the shared decision

Qualitative prioritization. Benefit, effort and feasibility require validation with Netflix teams

Option	Decision value	Relative effort	Call
Three-film shared shortlist	Tests agreement directly	Medium / high	Build first
Shared My List	Helps planning before viewing	Lower	Later
One surprise pick	Removes comparison, risks rejection	Lower	Defer
Conversational assistant	More expressive input, more interaction	Higher	Defer

MVP boundary Two adults. TV. Films. One market. Existing recommendation candidates.

Control and trust shape the implementation

Proposed logic reuses recommendation candidates, subject to feasibility and privacy review

Decision	MVP behavior
Who contributes	Use only opted-in profiles. Honor profile locks and the stricter restrictions.
What can appear	Filter by local availability, selected language and film runtime.
How to order	Combine candidate pools. Prefer films with acceptable fit for both viewers.
When confidence is low	Use stated preferences, explain limited fit, or return to regular browsing.

Session feedback stays separate

No personal history exposed. No silent individual taste updates.

Success is a faster start that viewers accept

All definitions and thresholds below are proposed. No baseline or result is claimed

Qualified start rate

A manual title start within 2 minutes, followed by 10 minutes of content playback in the next 15 minutes.

Denominator: all eligible TV home sessions in the enrolled cohort, including non-starts.

The clock starts before feature setup.

+3 pp

Illustrative minimum worthwhile lift

Guardrails

Each viewer's satisfaction
Early abandonment
TV latency and crashes

A household experiment measures impact

Recruit frequent co-viewers before randomization. Keep each household in one arm

A

Current TV experience

50% of enrolled households
Existing home and discovery paths

B

Choose together

50% of enrolled households
Optional entry on the same home

Baseline and A/A

2 weeks to validate events
and estimate variance

Powered A/B

At least 4 weeks, plus the
precomputed sample size

Decision rule

Meaningful, significant lift
Guardrails within bounds

NETFLIX

A small launch with a clear stop rule

Proposed rollout, gated by evidence rather than calendar promises

1%

Instrument

Check consent,
events and fallback

5%

Experiment

Run the powered
household A/B

25%

Broaden

Validate more devices
and local catalogs

Expand

Only if durable

Keep a holdout.
Watch repeat use.

**My product judgment: earn a better shared decision
with the smallest experience that can prove it.**